

COMMERCIAL & SAAS COLLECTIONS · REFERENCE

Disputed & Non-Responsive Invoices

How contested B2B invoices are validated — and how silent commercial accounts are actually recovered

Two situations account for most of the receivables a B2B or SaaS finance team cannot resolve on its own: the invoice a customer *disputes*, and the customer who simply stops responding. They look different but they share a solution — a documented, professional process that either resolves the dispute on its merits or applies escalating, lawful pressure until a silent account re-engages. This paper walks through both.

Part 1 — The disputed invoice

A dispute pauses recovery; it does not end it. A professional agency does not simply push harder on a contested balance — it runs a structured investigation to establish whether the dispute has merit before pursuing the account, which protects you from both write-offs and liability.

The documentation that resolves a dispute

The more complete the file, the faster a dispute is investigated and closed. For a contested B2B or SaaS invoice, the decisive records are:

DOCUMENT	WHY IT MATTERS
Signed order form, MSA or purchase order	Establishes the agreement, scope, price and terms both sides accepted.
Itemized invoices & statements	Shows exactly what was billed and reconciles line items against the order.
Proof of delivery / service completion	For SaaS, product usage logs and access records; for services, completion or acceptance records.
Full communication trail	Reminders, prior conversations and the customer's own dispute correspondence.

Legitimate dispute, or stall tactic?

With the file in hand, the agency contacts both sides to understand the disagreement, then determines legitimacy. The distinction matters: a genuine dispute is returned to you with a resolution recommendation; a stall tactic is worked through professionally with the documentation as leverage.

USUALLY LEGITIMATE	USUALLY A STALL TACTIC
Amount discrepancies that don't match the signed order or PO	"We never received the invoice" / routing or lost-paperwork claims
Documented quality or delivery problems	Vague dissatisfaction with no specifics
Genuine contract-interpretation disagreements with clear terms in play	Repeated new objections each time the last one is answered

A dispute investigation typically extends the collection timeline by 30–60 days, depending on complexity and how complete the documentation is — another reason to place while records are fresh and the paying contact is still reachable.

Part 2 — The non-responsive customer

The account that goes silent is the one an in-house AR team is least equipped to chase. Emails go unanswered, the billing contact has moved on, and the business may have restructured, rebranded or quietly wound down. Recovery here is about reach and persistence, applied lawfully.

Why B2B accounts go quiet

- The customer has decided to churn and simply stops engaging with billing.
- The original contact left; the invoice now lands in an inbox no one owns.
- The business moved, was acquired, rebranded, or spun down a division.
- Cash-flow trouble at the customer — the balance is real, but they are avoiding it.

How a silent account is actually recovered

An escalating, documented ladder

- **Third-party demand.** A formal demand on agency letterhead changes the customer's calculus — it signals the balance has left the vendor's AR queue and now carries consequences. This alone resolves a meaningful share of silent accounts.
- **Persistent multi-channel outreach.** Phone, email, letter and text on a consistent, documented cadence — the sustained follow-up an internal team rarely has capacity to maintain across every account.
- **Commercial skip tracing.** Locating the current operating entity, successor companies and the principals or guarantors behind a business that has moved, restructured or gone quiet — so demand reaches a party who can actually pay.
- **Legal escalation.** For balances that justify it and won't resolve through outreach, review of suit on the account and judgment enforcement with the client — a considered final resort, not a first move.

Commercial debt is not consumer debt

B2B commercial collections operate under different rules than consumer collections. The Fair Debt Collection Practices Act (FDCPA) governs consumer debt; a business-to-business obligation between two companies is not consumer debt, so those specific consumer restrictions do not apply. That gives commercial recovery more room to

operate — but a reputable agency still holds every account to a professional, documented, dispute-respecting standard, because in B2B markets your customer relationships and brand are on the line.

Why this protects Procurify, not just the balance

A past-due customer today can be a renewed customer tomorrow, and B2B markets are small. Firm recovery that stays professional and precisely documented resolves the balance while protecting the relationship and your brand — and shields you from the liability that aggressive or sloppy collections create.

Talk through a contested or silent account

Bring us a disputed invoice or a batch of non-responsive customers. We will tell you honestly what the documentation supports and how we would work it — on contingency, so there is no cost unless we recover.

Call (866) 551-4684 · sdietz@swrecovery.com · swrecovery.com

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